

FINANCIAL EQUITY RESEARCH

Microsoft Stock Performance Analysis

Microsoft Corporation (NASDAQ: MSFT) | Historical Market-Data Analysis (18 August 2025 – 17 August 2026)

REPORT FOCUS

Stock Performance Analysis

Technical & Volatility Profiling

PRIMARY DATA SOURCE

Cleaned MSFT Historical Series

OHLCV Market Data

SAMPLE SIZE

246 Trading Days

52-Week Full Coverage

CORE ANALYTICAL SCOPE

Trend, Returns & Drawdown

Moving Averages, Risk Ratios

1. Executive Summary

This financial report provides a comprehensive performance evaluation of Microsoft Corporation (MSFT) stock across 246 trading sessions from August 18, 2025 to August 17, 2026. The stock opened the period at \$517.10 and closed at \$485.16, generating an overall price return of -6.18%. During the observation horizon, MSFT registered a 52-week peak closing price of \$542.07 on October 28, 2025, and a cyclical trough of \$352.83 on June 25, 2026. The asset demonstrated an average daily trading volume of 31.42 million shares and an annualized return volatility of 32.42% (daily standard deviation: 2.04%).

STARTING CLOSE

\$517.10

Aug 18, 2025

ENDING CLOSE

\$485.16

Aug 17, 2026

HOLDING PERIOD RETURN

-6.18%

Absolute Performance

PERIOD PEAK CLOSE

\$542.07

Oct 28, 2025

AVERAGE CLOSE PRICE

\$447.81

Mean Valuation Base

AVERAGE DAILY VOLUME

31.42M

Shares per Session

DAILY VOLATILITY (Σ)

2.04%

32.42% Annualized

MAXIMUM DRAWDOWN

-34.91%

Peak-to-Trough Decline

2. Price Trend & Technical Indicator Analysis

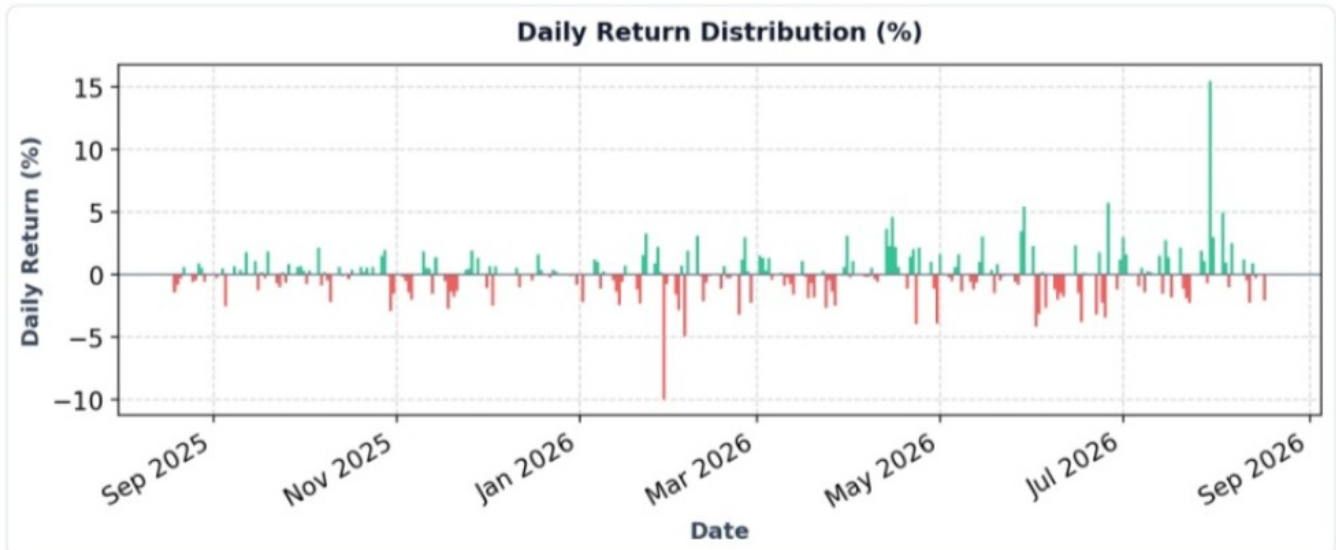
The 20-day and 50-day Simple Moving Averages (SMAs) highlight three distinct structural phases throughout the trading cycle:

- Consolidation & Peak (Q3–Q4 2025):** Stable valuation above \$500 supported by healthy liquidity, reaching the cycle high of \$542.07.
- Bearish Contraction & Downward Drift (Q1–Q2 2026):** A sustained break below both the 20-day and 50-day SMAs, establishing a major trough at \$352.83 in late June 2026.
- Aggressive Recovery Rally (July–August 2026):** Sharp upward momentum characterized by a strong crossover above short-term and medium-term trendlines, recovering toward \$485.16.



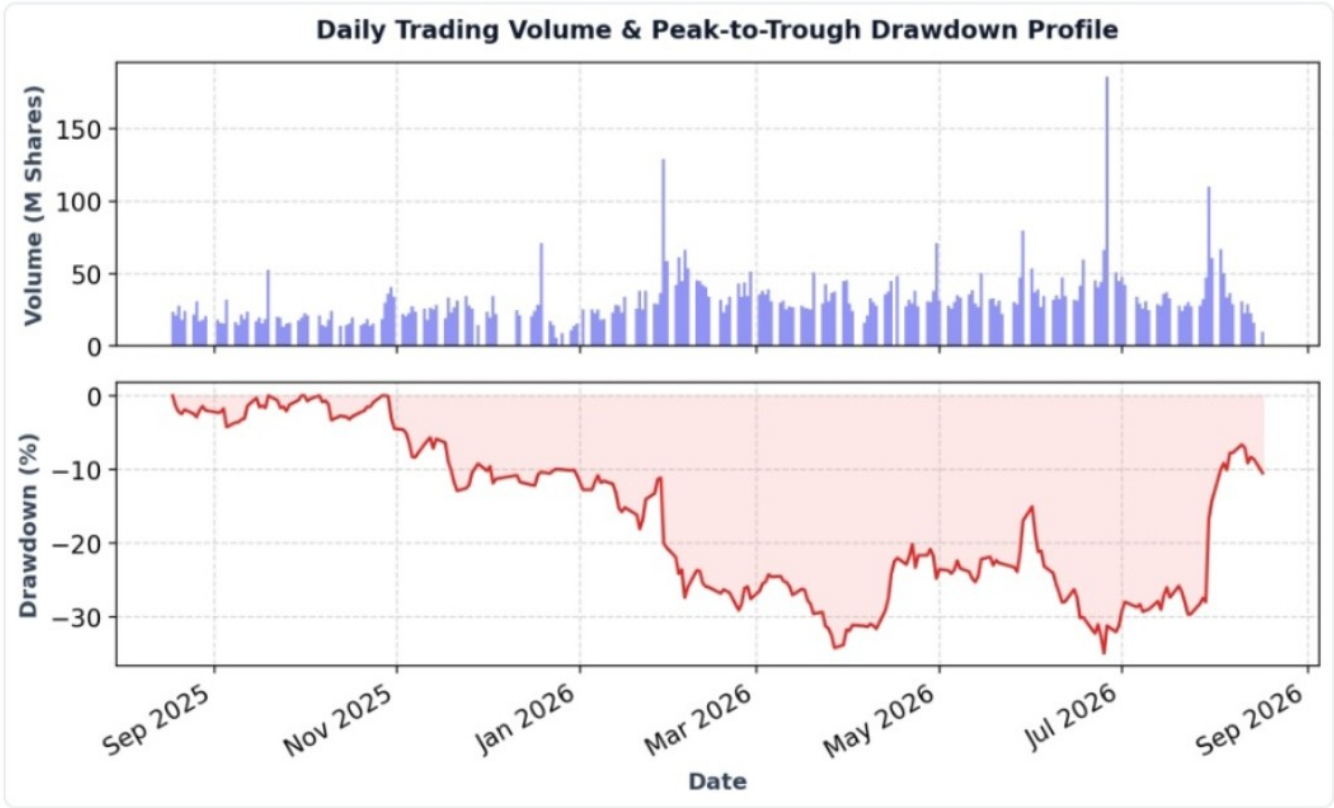
3. Return Distribution & Risk Profiling

Daily returns exhibited moderate kurtosis with episodic high-magnitude shocks. The single largest positive one-day return was **+15.51%** on July 30, 2026, followed by the largest single-day selloff of **-9.99%** on January 29, 2026. The median daily return settled at **-0.056%**, reflecting slight negative skewness during the downward trending months.



4. Liquidity Dynamics & Drawdown Profile

Trading volume spiked significantly during key market inflections, reaching an annual high of **186.20 million shares** on June 26, 2026. Peak-to-trough drawdown reached its maximum severe reading of **-34.91%** before experiencing a steep recovery toward **-10.50%** by August 2026.



5. Monthly Performance Breakdown

Period	Avg Close	Month-End	Avg Volume	High Close	Low Close	Monthly Return
2025-08	\$507.34	\$506.69	22.45M	\$517.10	\$502.04	-2.01%
2025-09	\$507.95	\$517.95	20.19M	\$517.95	\$495.00	+2.54%
2025-10	\$521.20	\$517.81	19.07M	\$542.07	\$510.96	-0.37%
2025-11	\$496.77	\$492.01	25.24M	\$517.03	\$472.12	-4.84%
2025-12	\$483.85	\$483.62	22.22M	\$490.00	\$476.12	-0.64%
2026-01	\$465.05	\$430.29	34.20M	\$483.47	\$430.29	-9.02%
2026-02	\$402.03	\$392.74	42.12M	\$423.37	\$384.47	-7.23%
2026-03	\$390.25	\$370.17	33.88M	\$410.68	\$356.77	-7.12%
2026-04	\$401.90	\$407.78	32.14M	\$432.92	\$369.37	+10.40%
2026-05	\$417.59	\$450.24	34.95M	\$450.24	\$405.21	+8.64%
2026-06	\$394.93	\$373.02	48.47M	\$460.52	\$352.83	-19.00%
2026-07	\$396.00	\$464.72	37.05M	\$464.72	\$381.58	+20.93%
2026-08	\$495.18	\$485.16	31.65M	\$506.06	\$485.16	-0.51%

6. Analytical Conclusions & Recommendations

Executive Insight: While MSFT demonstrated a net holding period loss (-6.18%), the sharp recovery in late Q3 2026 (+24.58% in July) illustrates strong accumulation support near the \$350–\$370 psychological valuation floor.

- **Fundamental Integration:** Complement price and volume indicators with financial metrics (P/E, EV/EBITDA, Cloud ARR growth, and Capex efficiency).
- **Benchmark Relative Valuation:** Evaluate alpha and beta metrics against the S&P 500 (SPY) and Nasdaq-100 (QQQ) to isolate idiosyncratic company risk from macroeconomic headwinds.
- **Risk Hedging:** Given the 34.91% maximum drawdown, portfolio managers should evaluate dynamic stop-loss rules or options collars during technical SMA death-cross regimes.

This document has been prepared for academic, analytical, and educational evaluation purposes based on historical market data.